

FAMILY COURT DATA REPORT · STATE SERIES · NO. 30

NEBRASKA

WHAT FAMILIES ARE REPORTING.

Pulled from the Family Rights Registry — a cross-location dataset on what pro se parents are actually experiencing inside Nebraska's family courts and child-welfare system.

51

NEBRASKA FAMILIES ON RECORD · 116 CHILDREN IMPACTED · 22 MONTHS MEDIAN MONTHS LOST OF PARENTING TIME

DATA AS OF
OCTOBER 14, 2026

COUNTIES REPRESENTED
23 OF 93

COMPILED BY
MEG · STANDWITHMEG.COM

01 NAMED COURT ACTORS · NEBRASKA

A name appears below only after 3 or more independent families have named the same actor in Nebraska. Submitter names, emails, and contact details are never published. Comments below are direct family reports — one per family — with all identifying information removed.

Audrey Long

GAL / CHILD REPRESENTATIVE · **8 SUBMISSIONS**

> *"She refused to listen to my children and their wants and need for their mother, she never attempted to unify me and my children. Even when I accomplished tasks, they asked me, nothing lived forward in a direction to me getting my children back.."*

> *"Was my court appointed attorney but never fought for me, asked the judge to extra time like I asked because I was post partum and had to walk everywhere"*

> *"She never listened to any of the concerns. The children told her about with their father and continue to be biased against myself."*

> *"She never used the evidence I gave her, or called anyone to testify on my behalf, she saw me as a crimnal and not a father."*

> *"She didn't even believe my toddler was autistic because she said she knows what autistic kids look like."*

> *"She didn't even try to represent me. She filed nothing in my case for me"*

> *"Was court appointed and didn't help once or try to help me get my kids"*

> *"DID NOT listen to my oldest daughter when she said she was abused!"*

Create Complaint Packet: https://my.standwithmeg.com/reports/actors/ne-audrey-long/complaint-packet
Family-reported pattern context only. Each person must file only their own truthful, first-hand complaint using their own facts, dates, evidence, orders, transcripts, and documents.

01 NAMED COURT ACTORS, CONTINUED

James Worden

JUDGE · **5 SUBMISSIONS**

> *"He ignored the kids please ignored my profession as a therapist ignored my status as a veteran, and only listened to their father who is still active duty and showed up in his uniform when he shouldn't be and they continue to address him as captain MCLAMB instead of the kids, father."*

> *"His mind was already made up, we were never attempted to reunify. He gave my kids to my exes parents because they looked more fit. Yet their kid is not a good person and they let him see my children whenever he wants, even though his rights are terminated as well."*

> *"Resigned in the middle of my case and would never listen to me even though my attorney didn't say anything in my defende"*

> *"He assumed I was a crazy mom cause I cried when they took my 2 yr old but let him visit his junkie dad unsupervised"*

> *"He just agreees with DHHS every time even when they lie"*

Create Complaint Packet: https://my.standwithmeg.com/reports/actors/ne-james-worden/complaint-packet
Family-reported pattern context only. Each person must file only their own truthful, first-hand complaint using their own facts, dates, evidence, orders, transcripts, and documents.

Kirk M. Fellhoelter

ATTORNEY · COUNT MY ATTORNEY · **4 SUBMISSIONS**

> *"He laughed at all of my concerns, and when I would talk about my children's special needs, tell me that I didn't know what I was talking about. He laughed at me quite a bit in court, and I asked the judge if this was allowed and I was ignored."*

> *"This man doesn't seem educated at all and always talks negative about everyone and doesn't care to find evidence to prove someone actually is a bad mom or dad"*

> *"He was so condescending when he looked at me and just didn't care what evidence there was"*

> *"He doesn't care what's right or wrong he labels you once he's seen you one time"*

Create Complaint Packet: https://my.standwithmeg.com/reports/actors/ne-kirk-m-fellhoelter/complaint-packet
Family-reported pattern context only. Each person must file only their own truthful, first-hand complaint using their own facts, dates, evidence, orders, transcripts, and documents.

01 NAMED COURT ACTORS, CONTINUED

Amanda Mathis

CPS WORKER · CASEWORKER · **3 SUBMISSIONS**

> *"She's a brand new Caseworker that started in October 2024 and was transferred to my case in March 2025 and was already at the process of removing my children without knowing who I was or who my children are and continued to say that I wouldn't work with family support workers. When I told her it was a conflict of interest because I had worked for those family support workers. She had lied many times in court."*

> *"She was friendly with my ex and listened and believed everything she said without any evidence."*

> *"Her supervisor Smith is also bad"*

Create Complaint Packet: https://my.standwithmeg.com/reports/actors/ne-amanda-mathis/complaint-packet
Family-reported pattern context only. Each person must file only their own truthful, first-hand complaint using their own facts, dates, evidence, orders, transcripts, and documents.

Dr. Gage Stermenski

PSYCHOLOGICAL EVALUATOR · PSYCHOLOGIST · **3 SUBMISSIONS**

> *"This man gave a biased parent capacity evaluation, saying that I was likely to be a not safe parent when I have never been accused of abusing my kids or neglecting my kids and I've taken care of them by myself for over 15 years, I know there was lots of personal disputes because his son is best friends with my nephew whom he blames for his son's behaviors ."*

> *"He said I was antisocial and I'm not. Never abused anyone always had a job. Always get along with ppl"*

> *"Put everything the CPS worker said in my report for my mental health"*

Create Complaint Packet: https://my.standwithmeg.com/reports/actors/ne-dr-gage-stermenski/complaint-packet
Family-reported pattern context only. Each person must file only their own truthful, first-hand complaint using their own facts, dates, evidence, orders, transcripts, and documents.

01 NAMED COURT ACTORS, CONTINUED

Katy Reichert

GAL / CHILD REPRESENTATIVE · SCOTTSBLUFF · **3 SUBMISSIONS**

> *"She was done with my kids case in the middle of it and transferred it to Audrey and accused me of taking doctors notes because that's what the school had said even though they were legitimate and I had sent her the legitimate doctors notes."*

> *"She dint care I was sober or doing better she had her mind made up"*

> *"She did not hear me out because I'm a ma"*

Create Complaint Packet: https://my.standwithmeg.com/reports/actors/ne-katy-reichert/complaint-packet
Family-reported pattern context only. Each person must file only their own truthful, first-hand complaint using their own facts, dates, evidence, orders, transcripts, and documents.

Public threshold rule: Names are grouped conservatively by normalized spelling, role, and location. Common titles, punctuation, casing, and middle initials collapse together. Close misspellings are not auto-merged without admin review. Only family-direct submissions count toward the public threshold.

THE HEADLINE NUMBERS

NEBRASKA AT A GLANCE.

Across 51 Nebraska families reporting through the Family Rights Registry, the patterns are consistent: long durations in court, serious financial loss, and a disproportionate number of parents going unrepresented because they ran out of money fighting.

CHILDREN IMPACTED
116
49 of 51 families reported child counts

MEDIAN FAMILY BURDEN
$113,000
median across 19 families reporting 3+ categories

MEDIAN MONTHS LOST
22
of parenting time

WENT PRO SE
49.0%
25 of 51 who answered; 11 of 51 ran out of money

SUBMISSIONS	AVG CHILDREN / FAMILY	FAMILIES REPORTING CHILDREN	COUNTIES REPRESENTED
51	2.4	49 of 51	23

WHY THIS REPORT EXISTS.

On January 29, 2024, I lost custody of all five of my children.

- NO TRIAL.
- NO QUESTIONING.
- NO SUBSTANTIATED ABUSE.

It took only a signature on an ex parte emergency order to erase a mother. I refused to disappear. I fought back, and built the Family Rights Registry so Nebraska families — and families across every represented location — would stop being invisible to the data. This report is their record.

— MEG · STANDWITHMEG.COM

03 THE COST OF NEBRASKA FAMILY COURT

Legal fees are the largest reported expense, but they are not the only one. Lost wages, evaluation costs, and reunification services compound the financial loss — pushing most families toward pro se representation once their savings run out.

EXPENSE CATEGORY	RESPONSES	MEDIAN	MEAN	TOTAL REPORTED
Attorney Fees	20	$30,000	$62,803	$1,256,062
Lost Wages	29	$54,200	$86,715	$2,514,722
Other Court Fees	12	$600	$6,281	$75,371
Therapy / Evaluations	17	$1,000	$6,747	$114,700
Reunification Services	12	$300	$6,992	$83,900
GAL Fees	7	$1,400	$29,071	$203,500
Asset Loss [1]	18	$50,000	—	—
Median Family Burden (19 families reporting 3+ categories)	—	**$113,000**	—	—

Median vs. mean: Median is the middle reported amount, so it better reflects the typical reporting family when a few very large expenses appear. Mean is the average across reporting families and can be pulled higher by outliers. **Median Family Burden** is the median of total reported expenses across families who reported costs in 3 or more expense categories with a combined total of at least $1,000 — a true median of real family totals, restricted to families who filled out enough of the financial section to characterize their case and excluding obvious data-entry artifacts.

1. On asset loss: One respondent reported an extreme outlier that skews the mean beyond usefulness. We report the median ($50,000) and suppress the mean and total, pending data-quality review. Lost Wages also contains wide variance; median is the honest headline.

LOST PARENTING TIME · MONTHS



04 WHO IS REPORTING · NEBRASKA

Most families documenting in Nebraska are currently active in, or recently closed out of, long-running cases. Nearly half have lost all contact with their children. Percentages below use only families who answered that specific topic.

CASE STATUS · SYSTEM AFFECTED

CASE STATUS

Active case: stuck or delayed	19	39%
Case closed: within last 2 years	10	20%
Not in court but still affected	5	10%
Case closed: more than 2 years ago	5	10%
Not provided	5	10%

SYSTEM AFFECTED

Both Family Court and CPS	30	59%
CPS Only	9	18%
Family Court Only	9	18%
Unknown	1	2%
False Allegations / Coached Claims	1	2%

DURATION · CUSTODY OUTCOMES

TIME IN SYSTEM

1 – 3 years	14	29%
3 – 5 years	12	24%
Over 10 years	8	16%
6 months – 1 year	6	12%
5 – 10 years	4	8%

CUSTODY STATUS

No Contact / Total Loss of Access	17	33%
Visitation Only	10	20%
50/50 Joint	8	16%
Full Custody	6	12%
Children in Foster Care	5	10%

GEOGRAPHY · ALLEGATIONS REPORTED

TOP COUNTIES

Douglas	8	18%
Scott'S Bluff	6	14%
Scotts Bluff	3	7%
Scottsbluff	3	7%
Lancaster	3	7%
Morrill	2	5%

TOP ALLEGATIONS REPORTED

Family Court False Accusations (Domestic Violence/Abuse/Alienation)	13	25%
False Accusations CPS (Non-Medical) (Vengeful ex-partner, malicious report)	12	24%
Other	9	18%
High Conflict Divorce	6	12%
Medical CPS (Medical Child Abuse allegations, disagreement with doctors)	4	8%

05 PARENT VOICES — NEBRASKA

Selected voice excerpts appear here for readability. Every approved, shareable Nebraska comment is printed in full in the appendix that follows.

> *Destroyed my family, my kids is relationship my children with my parents and my family aside. My son thinking that I was a horrible mom and that his sibling that ended up getting awarded back to me for horrible.*
>
> — ERIN

ON THE REPORTED ALLEGATIONS

Im currently sitting alone in my home cause my kids 4 are with my abusive parents one is somewhere in the state of Nebraska they won't tell me where my husband is in jail for 120 days for the false allegations the evidence the used was the arrest warrant and gal report to find [...]

— NEBRASKA PARENT · ANONYMOUS

MORE VOICES FROM NEBRASKA

My daughter is with her abuser and I have no contact. We are not a family any longer.

— CINDI

Judge/Attorney gave battering husband 50/50 custody of a premature newborn and 18 months old while a protection order was pending show cause hearing. My infant is 14 months old now and receiving disability services for her “developmental delay” (trauma response to [...]

— COURTNEY

It has absolutely destroyed my children and I.!!! It showed me just how evil this world truely is and I have lost all faith in our system.

— DENNIS

My children continue to suffer because family court judges are so focused on being “equal” that they don’t consider what is best for the children. The trauma never ends...

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

It has stolen memories and time with my children also my money

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

I was nieve. Destroyed my life and the rest of my families too.

— CHRISTOPHER

05 PARENT VOICES, CONTINUED

> *We were almost reunified and because CPS wouldn't listen to me on how things would go for my autistic son starting ABA. I went from having them 6days a week with 4 overnights to losing all visits for 2 weeks and now I only get 5hrs a week between 2days and being forced into [...]*
>
> — ANONYMOUS PARENT

Scotts Bluff County is disgustingly corrupt and you can tell that the attorneys talk to each other without their paid customers. No morals.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

Audrey would argue with the judges like her word was final say. She needs fired

— MISTY

The greatest tragedy is that the abuse didn't end at home —it continued through the system, leaving us trapped in a cycle of harm that the very institutions meant to protect us only deepened. Five years of litigation has left our family with lasting psychological trauma. We have [...]

— JENNIFER

someone told that the attorney is the guardian ad litem, and the judge talk together outside of the support room and I didn't believe it. It's until I went through this case myself. It was almost like the hearings were rehearsed, my own attorney included.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

Scottsbluff just wants to keep funding the sick individuals who think taking kids is "in their best interest" when they have loving parents

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

Bruner Frank law firm needs to be investigated. Judge John Marsh needs recused. The entire system has blood on their hands.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

Its taken my children, my career, my home I set up for my children and I after the separation, my assets. It has financially bankrupt myself and my mom who has helped me through all of this

— PAIGE

Tore my family apart, foster family treats my kids poorly because of bio kids, foster parents as cps worker speak badly of me to the kids and say they're never coming home.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

05 PARENT VOICES, CONTINUED

> *This system weaponized my relationships with my children as the most effective tool of abuse someone who would create such pain can wield. The system has become the very evil thing they claim to protect us from and society is well on its way to paying a great price for removing [...]*
>
> — DAVE

After working for DHHS and wanting to be the person to help me make a positive change and then seeing how DHHS tore my family apart, it showed how much people care more about power and being right than what is in the right interest of children. Now as a therapist, I hope it can [...]

— ANGELICA

Demolished relationships woth my children and I. Saratoga the Mother children relationship

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

Given my children back to an abusive ex/dad despite the obvious proof.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

Destroyed family entirely. Brothers alienated. Parents villified. Grandparents shut out. Relationships never recovered.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

The state's unlawful separation of a parent and child inflicts an immediate, irreparable injury that permanently fractures the family structure. This profound trauma cannot be undone or mitigated by the eventual recognition of the parent's innocence.

— MANUEL

Juvenile court has become punitive and not rehabilitative. The state is making money off of destroying families

— TREY

They've kidnapped my kids and villainized me when I had nothing to do with the original reason for removal. This system made me their circus animal, jumping through all their hoops and meeting all their demands and still never give my kids back to me. They even put a no contact [...]

— GRADY

Family court has effectively deprived me of a meaningful relationship with my children by restricting my parenting time and limiting my ability to maintain consistent, direct involvement in their lives.

— JEN

05 PARENT VOICES, CONTINUED

> *The system that I relied so heavily on to protect me and my family as law abiding citizens has ripped my entire purpose for this life from me with no end in sight. How do people survive fighting this?*
>
> — LINDSAY

Destroying us ...the stress, the money, the physical wear on us...after all the lies...the time we have missed with our family/kids!!! The system is wrong and should be 100% about helping the family to be as one....it's more about the money and in the process mentally harming [...]

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

assistant initially removed me from my own mother and turned around and give her guardianship of my children, ignoring the facts writing the narrative to fit their own bias

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Having your newborn taken away and given false hope that if you recover and get better that you'll get your child back, I've never felt so hopeless, helpless and angry.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

Allowing my daughter to continue to be abused. It is changing her as a person., her behavior, her physical health and her ability to tell between right and wrong.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

Tore use apart i never did drugs of any sort till my children were taken from me I now have ptsd bipolar anxiety depression sleeping disorder I now have my 19 year old and my 18 year old do to one being forced to marry to get out of the system adopted father was the minister for [...]

— AMBER

Tarished and hurt, financially hurt too

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

I hate to admit, but I gave up because I haven't seen anyone else win in this "good ole boy" town. I'm hoping one day my son will understand I don't want him to have to go through watching me lose him

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

I am required by law to hand my daughter over to her rapist, unsupervised, and I know that if I try to fight him through courts that I risk loosing her because dhhs covered it up.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

05 PARENT VOICES, CONTINUED

> *Destroied my family.*
>
> — ANONYMOUS PARENT

36 Nebraska parents submitted approved, shareable comments. 36 selected excerpts appear here; the full comments begin on the next page.

06 FULL PARENT COMMENTS — NEBRASKA

The comments below are the full approved, publicly shareable survey comments from Nebraska families. Data-only and do-not-share submissions are excluded from this public appendix.

> Destroyed my family, my kids is relationship my children with my parents and my family aside. My son thinking that I was a horrible mom and that his sibling that ended up getting awarded back to me for horrible.
>
> — ERIN

> My daughter is with her abuser and I have no contact. We are not a family any longer.
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We were almost reunified and because CPS wouldn't listen to me on how things would go for my autistic son starting ABA. I went from having them 6days a week with 4 overnights to losing all visits for 2 weeks and now I only get 5hrs a week between 2days and being forced into guardianship or losing my rights completely. So I would say they are the ones who are traumatizing my children

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

Scotts Bluff County is disgustingly corrupt and you can tell that the attorneys talk to each other without their paid customers. No morals.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

Im currently sitting alone in my home cause my kids 4 are with my abusive parents one is somewhere in the state of Nebraska they won't tell me where my husband is in jail for 120 days for the false allegations the evidence the used was the arrest warrant and gal report to find him guilty he lost his job he had for 5 years his saving for retirement has been completed drained cause we have had to pay to just to keep afloat and since he is in jail im trying and dont know if i can do it working part time my kids lost all there animals cause they showed in the fair my they are very passionate about that my mother made that happen cause we both got arrest and I dont think she told them the had purple ribbon rabbits children geese oldest has a hog dogs cats they lost them all we lost our only good running vehicle

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

Audrey would argue with the judges like her word was final say. She needs fired

— MISTY

The greatest tragedy is that the abuse didn’t end at home—it continued through the system, leaving us trapped in a cycle of harm that the very institutions meant to protect us only deepened. Five years of litigation has left our family with lasting psychological trauma. We have lived in survival mode for so long that fear, uncertainty, and chronic stress became our normal. The financial devastation, emotional scars, and years we lost can never be restored. What began as a custody case changed every part of our lives, and its impact will remain with our family long after the case is over.

— JENNIFER

06 FULL PARENT COMMENTS, CONTINUED

someone told that the attorney is the guardian ad litem, and the judge talk together outside of the support room and I didn't believe it. It's until I went through this case myself. It was almost like the hearings were rehearsed, my own attorney included.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

Scottsbluff just wants to keep funding the sick individuals who think taking kids is "in their best interest" when they have loving parents

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— ANONYMOUS PARENT

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— PAIGE

Tore my family apart, foster family treats my kids poorly because of bio kids, foster parents as cps worker speak badly of me to the kids and say they're never coming home.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

This system weaponized my relationships with my children as the most effective tool of abuse someone who would create such pain can wield. The system has become the very evil thing they claim to protect us from and society is well on its way to paying a great price for removing millions of loving parents from the children who require their loving embrace.

— DAVE

06 FULL PARENT COMMENTS, CONTINUED

After working for DHHS and wanting to be the person to help me make a positive change and then seeing how DHHS tore my family apart, it showed how much people care more about power and being right than what is in the right interest of children. Now as a therapist, I hope it can help others, including my own children someday heal from this trauma.

— ANGELICA

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— ANONYMOUS PARENT

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— GRADY

06 FULL PARENT COMMENTS, CONTINUED

Family court has effectively deprived me of a meaningful relationship with my children by restricting my parenting time and limiting my ability to maintain consistent, direct involvement in their lives.

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The system that I relied so heavily on to protect me and my family as law abiding citizens has ripped my entire purpose for this life from me with no end in sight. How do people survive fighting this?

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— ANONYMOUS PARENT

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06 FULL PARENT COMMENTS, CONTINUED

> Tore use apart i never did drugs of any sort till my children were taken from me I now have ptsd bipolar anxiety depression sleeping disorder I now have my 19 year old and my 18 year old do to one being forced to marry to get out of the system adopted father was the minister for that my 18 year old had to goto a different state where she was 18 as an adult to get out of the system my 17 year old is with my little brother do to the adopted parents not wanting him anymore so they past him to my mother which in turn tried ruining his scolorship then got caught and is not with my brother and is doing great
>
> — AMBER

> Tarished and hurt, financially hurt too
>
> — ANONYMOUS PARENT

> I hate to admit, but I gave up because I haven't seen anyone else win in this "good ole boy" town. I'm hoping one day my son will understand I don't want him to have to go through watching me lose him
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> I am required by law to hand my daughter over to her rapist, unsupervised, and I know that if I try to fight him through courts that I risk loosing her because dhhs covered it up.
>
> — ANONYMOUS PARENT

> Destroied my family.
>
> — ANONYMOUS PARENT

36 full approved Nebraska comments are included in this appendix.

07 HOW TO READ THIS REPORT

WHAT THIS IS

The Family Rights Registry is a public, parent-reported data collection run by Stand With Meg. Every figure in this Nebraska report comes from Nebraska respondents who voluntarily submitted survey entries about their experience inside family court and/or CPS.

This report is built to help families, advocates, reporters, and legislators see the patterns emerging in Nebraska — not to replace formal research, and not to name individual judges or counties as responsible parties.

WHAT IT ISN'T

This is not a representative sample. Respondents self-select. The 51 Nebraska families reporting here are not the universe of Nebraska families in court — they are the families who found the survey, trusted it enough to submit, and told us what happened to them.

Financial figures are self-reported. Response counts and percentages use the number of families who answered that specific topic or financial field. The Median Family Burden headline is the median of total reported expenses across families who reported in three or more expense categories. Quotes are minimally edited.

METHODOLOGY · FAMILY RIGHTS REGISTRY

Data in this report was collected April 2024 – October 2026 through standwithmeg.com/family-rights-survey. Submissions are timestamped. Duplicate-submission heuristics use normalized email + location, with direct survey rows preferred over legacy rows and the newest row retained within each source. Categorical responses from multi-select and short-answer fields are normalized monthly.

Dollar fields exclude blank, negative, and obvious data-entry artifact values above the report's field caps. When asset-loss values contain a strong statistical outlier, the asset-loss mean and total are suppressed and only the median is reported. Lost-wage, attorney-fee, and asset-loss entries are self-reported and not corroborated against tax records or court filings.

Geographic reporting uses the county or regional field as submitted, with light normalization (e.g. "Butte silverbow" → "Butte–Silver Bow"). Quotes carry one of three public permission states: *Anonymous*, *First-name only*, or *Full attribution with consent to public use*. Court actor names appear only after 3 independent families name the same actor.

STANDWITHMEG.COM · COURAGE TO STAND, POWER TO CHANGE

ABOUT THIS REPORT

This report is based on self-reported survey submissions collected by Stand With Meg. Counts and categories reflect responses available at the time this packet was generated.

This report is for informational and advocacy use only, not legal advice or an official government record.

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